



Incident handler's journal

Date: September 21, 2026 .	Entry: #1
Description	Documenting a ransomware security incident at a small health care clinic.
Tool(s) used	None.
The 5 W's	• Who caused the incident? An organized group of unethical hackers caused the incident. The attackers targeted the clinic through phishing emails sent to several employees. • What happened? A malicious attachment in a phishing email installed malware, allowing the attackers to gain access to the clinic's network and deploy ransomware. The ransomware encrypted critical files, including medical records, and disrupted business operations. • When did the incident occur?

	The incident was discovered on Tuesday at approximately 9:00 a.m. Employees reported that they could not access important files and software needed to perform their jobs. • Where did the incident happen? The incident occurred within a small U.S. health care clinic that provides primary-care services. The attack affected the clinic's computer systems and access to critical patient data. • Why did the incident happen? The incident happened because attackers used targeted phishing emails to gain access to the clinic's network and then deployed ransomware. The ransom note demanded a large sum of money in exchange for the decryption key, indicating a financial motive.
Additional notes	The incident caused major disruption because employees could not access critical patient information or software. Questions to consider include how the clinic can improve phishing awareness and security controls to prevent a similar ransomware attack in the future.